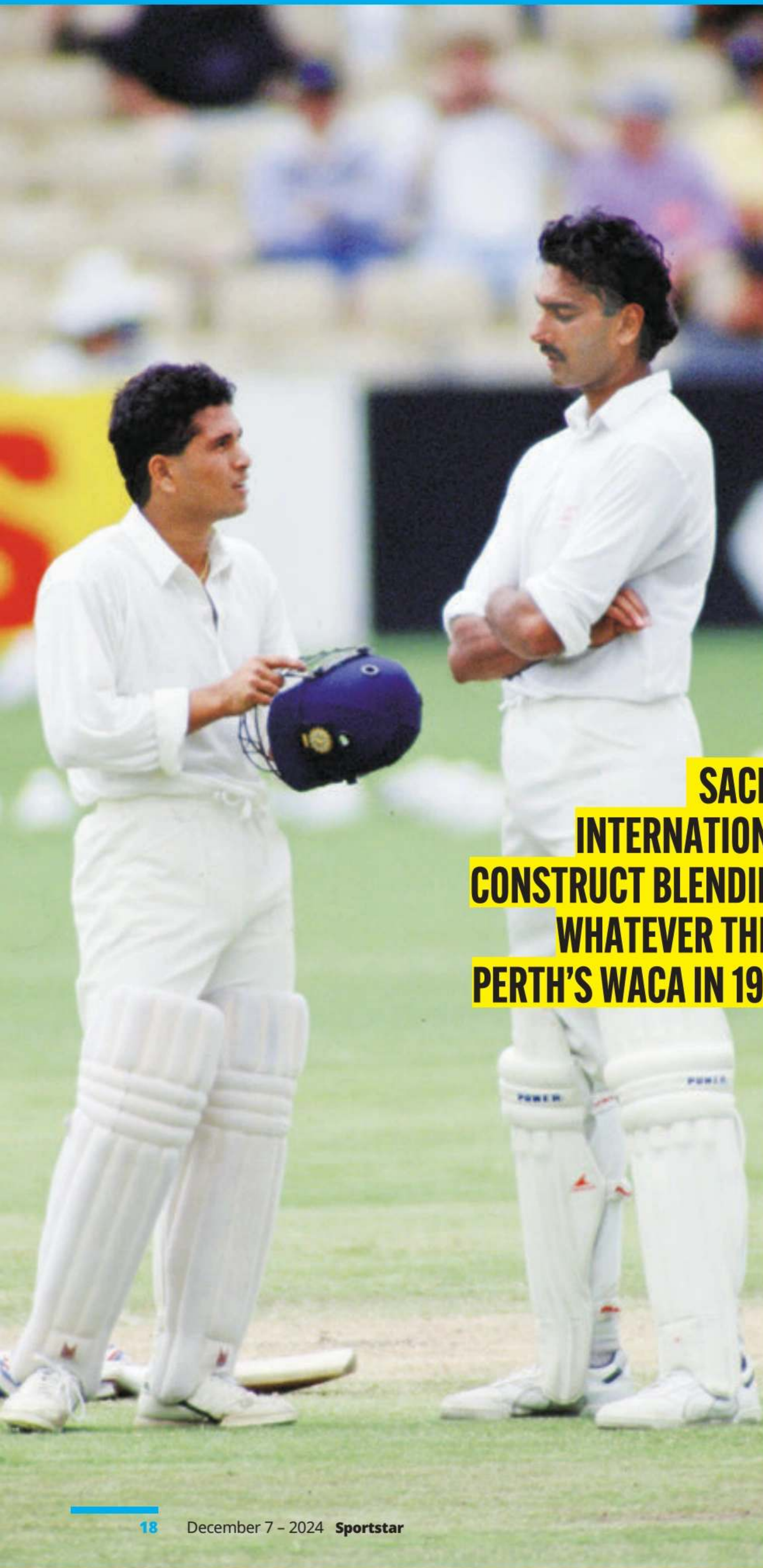




From the vault: Ravi Shastri is another thread that binds India and Australia. During the 1991-92 tour of Australia that India lost 0-4, Shastri scored a double ton in Sydney while also keeping a sharp eye on a young Sachin Tendulkar. THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

Tests, it seemed as if the script would only get worse as despite Gundappa Viswanath's superb 114, India watched Australia ride high on Allan Border's 124 and gain a 182-run first-innings lead. Sunil Gavaskar's men then posted 324 in the second dig, setting a meagre 143-run target. All seemed lost, but when Viswanath told an injured Kapil Dev that India had never lost when the former scored a ton, the latter was charged up.

Kapil's five-for, with Karsan Ghavri and Dilip Doshi lending support, dismantled the Aussies. India won by 59 runs, and the series was levelled.

SACHIN TENDULKAR HAS 100 INTERNATIONAL TONS, AN ARTIFICIAL CONSTRUCT BLENDING TESTS AND ODIS, BUT WHATEVER THE SEMANTICS, HIS 114 AT PERTH'S WACA IN 1992 IS STILL CONSIDERED HIS BEST OUTING

In the same tour, Sandeep Patil scored a blistering 174 in the second Test at Adelaide. This was an era of slow living and an absence of raucous social media, and it is understandable that the 1980-81 tour is often forgotten while Waugh's failed mission to conquer the Last Frontier in 2001 is regarded as the starting point of a storied rivalry.

Ravi Shastri, a superb all-rounder and a commentator in love with tracer bullets, remains another thread that binds India and Australia.